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B.P.P. AND CITIZENS' COMMITTEE

DEMAND PROBE INTO ABUSES OF CIVIL RIGHTS GROUPS



Massive street demonstration in Harlem, 1968. A probe of governmental attempts to curtail the activities of civil rights groups is being demanded by concerned citizens.

(Oakland, Calif.) - A citizens' committee representing a cross-section of persons concerned about the abuses of civil rights organizations at the hands of federal law enforcement agencies last week called upon the Congressional committees investigating the CIA (Central Intelligence Agency) to focus their inquiries on these abuses.

In a lengthy letter to Senator Frank Church and Rep. Lucien Nedzi, chairmen of the Senate and House committees investigating the CIA and other intelligence agencies respectively, the Committee for Justice for Huey P. Newton and the Black Panther Party noted that to date no investigation of the law enforcement and intelligence agencies has specifically inquired into abuses against minority and civil rights groups.

Robert McAfee Brown, spokesperson for the Committee for Justice, said that "those groups most in need of Congressional protection against abuses by federal officials of their civil liberties have been the last to get it. Instead, powerful and established organizations have been the chief beneficiaries of Congressional inquiries into domestic surveillance and harassment."

The group cited internal memoranda brought to light by lawsuits filed against government intelligence agencies as evidence to support their request for a Congressional inquiry. The letter concluded by offering "the technical support of our Committee, including our legal counsel, if you will pledge to seek the truth in these matters."

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